

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
Sept. 3, 2026

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**Gov. Braun Awards Grant to Transform Rural Healthcare
in Northwest Indiana Region**

Indianapolis, IN- Gov. Mike Braun announced today that the northwest Indiana region (Region 1) has been awarded \$12.6 million in Growing Rural Opportunities for Well-being (GROW) initiative grants. GROW region one includes Fulton, Jasper, Marshall, Newton, Elkhart, Pulaski, and Starke counties.

GROW is focused on improving healthcare access, quality and outcomes in rural communities across the state of Indiana and supported by the Indiana Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP), administered by the Indiana Department of Health (IDOH) and Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA). Indiana received nearly \$207 million for the first year of the five-year federal Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) grant program. About \$120 million, or 60% of that funding, was earmarked for the regional grants.

"The Trump Administration's Rural Health Transformation Program is based on one simple idea: your access to quality health care shouldn't depend on your ZIP code," said CMS Administrator Dr. Mehmet Oz. "Funding new approaches to expand access and improve health outcomes for rural Hoosiers is an important step toward achieving that vision and I look forward to seeing RHTP dollars support equally transformative innovations for rural communities nationwide."

"This funding is a major step forward in our commitment to making health care affordable and accessible for all Hoosiers," Gov. Braun said. "It's an important stride toward creating a more sustainable and connected network in rural Indiana."

Region 1 GROW grant activities include:

- **Regional Community Navigation & Care Coordination Network:** Aims to build trusted relationships that help residents navigate healthcare and community resources through coordinated referrals and support.

- **Healthcare Innovation & Digital Care Expansion:** Committed to strengthening digital health infrastructure, telehealth, interoperability, and public health intelligence to improve coordination and decision-making.
- **Healthcare Access Expansion & Mobile Care Delivery:** Prioritizes access expansion to primary care, specialty care, preventive services, and coordinated clinical care throughout Region 1.
- **Integrate Rural Access Network:** Helps lower barriers to care and addresses social drivers of health through AI-enabled healthcare navigation and virtual low acuity care, transportation, community-based access hubs, food as medicine partnerships, maternal health supports, and other community-based services.
- **Healthcare Workforce Development & Talent Pipeline Network:** Promotes a strengthened healthcare workforce through coordinated planning, clinical training, education to employment pathways, and the Regional Workforce Information System (RWIS).

Rural Health Transformation Program's GROW will now move into implementation building on a foundation of strong collaboration, local leadership and meaningful impact from targeted activities.

Region 1's award complements the seven other regions that received GROW regional grants. RHTP also includes 11 statewide initiatives that promote workforce investment, thoughtful partnerships and infrastructure development. Additional information about the GROW regional grants and 11 statewide initiatives are available on the RHTP website growruralhealth.in.gov.

This Rural Health Transformation Program is supported by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) of the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) as part of a financial assistance award totaling \$206,927,896.80 with 100 percent funded by CMS/HHS. The contents are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily represent the official views of, nor an endorsement, by CMS/HHS, or the U.S. Government.

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